

Conclusively identified as **Lithobates catesbeianus!**

Classification result (scientific name, common name, confidence %)

|                                                |       |
|------------------------------------------------|-------|
| 1. Lithobates catesbeianus (American Bullfrog) | 78.1% |
| 2. Pelophylax ridibundus (Marsh Frog)          | 8.6%  |
| 3. Lithobates clamitans (Green Frog)           | 3.9%  |

► Show thinking (5 steps)

What it is

*Lithobates catesbeianus*, commonly called the **American bullfrog**, is a large frog native to eastern North America. It lives in permanent wetlands such as ponds, lakes and swamps, and can also use artificial water bodies.

It is a generalist, opportunistic predator. Its broad diet allows it to prey on native frogs and other animals. The field-guide material also notes concern that bullfrogs can carry and spread the amphibian disease chytridiomycosis (*Batrachochytrium dendrobatidis*).

Status in the UK

The returned field-guide information says that **self-sustaining populations became established in the UK around 1999**, probably through accidental escapes and deliberate releases from captivity. It describes these populations as small and subject to control by **Natural England** because of the threat to native amphibians.

However, the dedicated status check did **not** return an explicit current UK legal designation or a definitive UK reference-table entry. So I can confirm that it is treated as an invasive concern in the field-guide material, but I cannot confirm a precise current legal listing from the available sources.

What you should do

If you think you have found one:

- **Do not release, transport, or move it** to another pond or water body.
- Do not move water, mud, nets, boots or other equipment between ponds, given the disease-spread concern.
- Record the exact location and date, and take a photograph from a safe distance if possible.
- Report it as a **suspected American bullfrog** to Natural England in England, or to the relevant nature-conservation authority elsewhere in the UK. Ask them for the current reporting and handling procedure.
- **Do not attempt to remove, kill or control it yourself**, particularly because the current legal position was not confirmed by the returned information.
- If it is a captive animal, **do not release it**; contact the relevant environmental authority before arranging any transfer or surrender.

🚫 **This may be a regionally invasive species** — check local reporting/disposal rules before doing anything with it.

Sources:

- Wikipedia, "American bullfrog" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American\\_bullfrog](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_bullfrog)
- Wikipedia, "Lithobates clamitans" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates\\_clamitans](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates_clamitans)
- Wikipedia, "Smooth newt" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Smooth\\_newt](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Smooth_newt)

What is the scientific name of the American bullfrog and where is it native to?

► Show thinking (2 steps)

The American bullfrog's scientific name is ***Lithobates catesbeianus***. It is native to **eastern North America**, particularly the United States east of the Mississippi River.

Sources:

- Wikipedia, "American bullfrog" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American\\_bullfrog](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_bullfrog)
- Wikipedia, "Lithobates clamitans" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates\\_clamitans](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates_clamitans)

Why is it called a "bullfrog"?

► Show thinking (2 steps)

It is called a **"bullfrog"** because the male's loud breeding call sounds like a bull bellowing.

Sources:

- Wikipedia, "American bullfrog" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American\\_bullfrog](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_bullfrog)
- Wikipedia, "Lithobates clamitans" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates\\_clamitans](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates_clamitans)

What types of habitats does the American bullfrog typically inhabit?

► Show thinking (2 steps)

The American bullfrog typically inhabits **large, permanent freshwater bodies**, especially:

- Swamps
- Ponds
- Lakes

It also uses human-made aquatic habitats such as **pools, koi ponds, canals, ditches, reservoirs, and culverts**.

Sources:

- Wikipedia, "American bullfrog" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American\\_bullfrog](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_bullfrog)
- Wikipedia, "Lithobates clamitans" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates\\_clamitans](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates_clamitans)

Is the American bullfrog considered an invasive species? If so, where?

► Show thinking (4 steps)

Yes. The American bullfrog (*Lithobates catesbeianus*) is considered **invasive in many places where it has been introduced outside its native eastern North American range**.

The field guide reports introductions in **more than 40 countries**, including:

- The **western United States** and southern British Columbia
- **Mexico**
- The **Caribbean**, including Cuba, Jamaica, Hispaniola, and Puerto Rico
- **South America**, including Argentina, Brazil, Colombia, Uruguay, and Venezuela
- **Western Europe**, including Belgium, Italy, Spain, Greece, and the Netherlands
- Parts of **Asia**, including China, Japan, South Korea, Malaysia, and Southeast Asia

In the **United Kingdom**, small self-sustaining populations were reported around 1999, and the species is treated as an invasive concern. The field guide does not establish that every listed country has a formal legal invasive-species designation; it supports the broader conclusion that the species is invasive in introduced settings.

🚫 **This may be a regionally invasive species** — check local reporting/disposal rules before doing anything with it.

Sources:

- Wikipedia, "American bullfrog" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American\\_bullfrog](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_bullfrog)
- Wikipedia, "Lithobates clamitans" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates\\_clamitans](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates_clamitans)
- Wikipedia, "Lysichiton americanus" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lysichiton\\_americanus](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lysichiton_americanus)

Why are bullfrogs considered invasive and harmful to local ecosystems?

► Show thinking (4 steps)

American bullfrogs are considered invasive **when introduced outside their native range** because several traits allow them to establish and disrupt local food webs:

- **Broad, generalist diet:** They eat prey from many environments, including native frogs and other amphibians, fish, insects, crustaceans, reptiles, birds, and small mammals.
- **Predation on native frogs:** They directly consume indigenous frog species, and this has been associated with declines in native frogs.
- **High reproductive output:** They produce large numbers of eggs, helping populations grow rapidly after introduction.
- **Disruption of natural controls:** Adult bullfrogs eat predators of their own young—such as dragonfly nymphs, garter snakes, and giant water bugs—making natural control of bullfrog juveniles less effective.
- **Potential effects on endemic species:** Their ecological niche can shift in new environments, creating a threat even to endemic frogs that do not initially appear to compete with them.
- **Disease transmission:** Introduced bullfrogs have been associated with spreading *Batrachochytrium dendrobatidis* (Bd), an amphibian pathogen that can kill amphibians.

Thus, the concern is not simply that bullfrogs are large predators, but that they combine **wide-ranging predation, high reproduction, disruption of food webs, and possible disease transmission**. The field guide supports this invasive designation in introduced regions, although the safety check did not identify a specific legal designation.

⚠️ **This may be toxic or otherwise dangerous** — read the notes below before acting.

🚫 **This may be a regionally invasive species** — check local reporting/disposal rules before doing anything with it.

Sources:

- Wikipedia, "American bullfrog" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American\\_bullfrog](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_bullfrog)
- Wikipedia, "Lithobates clamitans" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates\\_clamitans](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates_clamitans)

What does the American bullfrog look like in terms of coloration?

► Show thinking (2 steps)

The American bullfrog is typically:

- **Upper surface:** olive-green, either fairly plain or marked with **grayish-brown mottling and bands**
- **Underparts:** **off-white**, often blotched with **yellow or gray**
- **Limbs:** marked with **gray blotches or bands**
- **Face:** often has a strong contrast between the **green upper lip** and **pale lower lip**
- **Males:** commonly have a **yellow throat**

Sources:

- Wikipedia, "American bullfrog" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American\\_bullfrog](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_bullfrog)
- Wikipedia, "Lithobates clamitans" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates\\_clamitans](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates_clamitans)

For what purposes are bullfrogs used by humans?

► Show thinking (2 steps)

Humans use American bullfrogs mainly for:

- **Food:** They are commonly eaten, particularly as frog legs. They may be caught in the wild or raised in captivity.
- **Education and research:** They are used as specimens for dissection in biology and anatomy classes.
- **Biological control:** In some places, people have intentionally introduced them for use as biological control agents.
- **Commercial farming:** Bullfrog-raising has been promoted as a source of income and a way to produce frogs for food.

Sources:

- Wikipedia, "American bullfrog" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American\\_bullfrog](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_bullfrog)
- Wikipedia, "Lithobates clamitans" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates\\_clamitans](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates_clamitans)

Who is the species named after?

► Show thinking (2 steps)

*Lithobates catesbeianus* is named in honor of **Mark Catesby**, an English naturalist.

Sources:

- Wikipedia, "American bullfrog" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American\\_bullfrog](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_bullfrog)
- Wikipedia, "Lithobates clamitans" — [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates\\_clamitans](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates_clamitans)

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